

VEER

Making Claude Remember You

Set it up once. Stop explaining yourself every time.

You are here

By the end of this guide you'll be able to:

Stop re-typing the same background at the start of every conversation.

Write down who you are, once, in a form that improves every answer.

Set standing rules for how you want things written.

Build a workspace for one recurring part of your life.

Give it your own reference material so it works from your facts.

Keep things separate when they should be.

Keep it current as your circumstances change.

This is the shortest book in the series and the one that saves the most time per page.

01

Why you keep repeating yourself

If you've used this for a few weeks you'll have noticed the tax.

Every new conversation begins with the same three sentences. /
*run a small gardening business. I'm writing to a customer. I don't
like anything too formal.*

Type that four hundred times a year and it becomes the reason
you stop bothering for small things.

The fix is to say it once and have it apply from then on. That's
the whole subject of this book.

Two separate ideas, and it's worth keeping them apart:

Who you are and what your situation is. Facts that don't change week to week.

How you want it to behave. Length, tone, what to always do, what never to do.

The first improves the *content* of answers. The second improves the *form*. Most people set neither, then wonder why every answer needs the same three corrections.

THE TEST FOR WHETHER THIS IS WORTH DOING

Have you typed the same background sentence more than three times? Then it belongs somewhere permanent.

Try this now. Think back over your last few conversations. What did you explain more than once?

02

Writing down who you are

The highest-value ten minutes in this series, and it's a piece of writing rather than a setting.

Five or six sentences. Enough that a capable stranger could write on your behalf; not so much that the important parts get buried.

What earns its place:

What you do, in a sentence. Work, or how you spend your time.

Who's around you if it's relevant. Family, customers, the people you write to.

How you sound. Warm and brief. Plain, no exclamation marks. Dry.

What you're usually trying to do. Understand things, write things, plan things.

Anything that changes every answer. Where you live, if that matters. A constraint you always have.

IF WRITING IT FEELS AWKWARD

Ask me questions about myself, my situation and how I like things written, until you have enough to write a short "about me" paragraph I can reuse. Then write it in the first person.

Answering questions is easier than composing from nothing, and it usually produces something better than you'd have written cold.

KEEP IT TO WHAT'S USEFUL, NOT WHAT'S PRIVATE

This is a description of your situation, not your file. Your health, your finances, other people's private details — leave them out and mention them only in the specific conversation where they matter. See [Is This Safe?](#)

Try this now. Write the six sentences, or have it interview you. Keep them somewhere you can copy from.

03

Standing rules for how you like things

The second half. Not who you are — how you want it to behave.

Most people's rules are the corrections they keep having to make. Notice what you type twice a week and turn it into a rule.

Common ones worth having:

Keep answers short unless I ask for detail.

Don't open with a summary of my own question.

No exclamation marks, and don't tell me a question is a great question.

If you're unsure, say so rather than guessing.

When I ask for writing, give me the writing without an explanation of it.

Write rules as behaviour, not personality. "Be concise" is vague. "Answers under 150 words unless I ask for more" is a rule it can follow.

Add them as you notice them. The good set is built over a month of noticing your own corrections, not written in one sitting.

THE ONE MOST PEOPLE WANT FIRST

"Don't be effusive. No praise, no enthusiasm about the task, no offering three follow-up suggestions I didn't ask for." Whether that's an improvement is a matter of taste — but a lot of people find it is, and never realise they can ask.

Try this now. Write down the three corrections you make most often. Those are your first three rules.

04

A workspace for one part of your life

The next step up. Rather than one setup for everything, keep a separate space for a recurring situation, with its own background and its own rules.

Worth having its own space:

A hobby or a subject you're learning, where the vocabulary and your level are constant.

A recurring responsibility — a committee, a club, caring for a relative.

Work, if you'd rather keep it apart from everything else.

A long project, where every conversation needs the same background.

Set the background at the level of the situation, not the task.

This is for helping me care for my mother, who is 84 and lives alone — then every conversation in that space starts from there.

The benefit is cumulative. Conversation twenty starts as well-informed as conversation one ended, without you doing anything.

DON'T OVER-ORGANISE

Two or three spaces for things you genuinely return to. Not fifteen. A structure you have to maintain is a structure you'll abandon, and everything here still works from an ordinary conversation.

Try this now. Name the one part of your life you'd most like it to already understand.

05

Giving it your own reference material

The step that changes the quality most, and the one fewest people take.

Alongside a description, you can give a workspace **documents** — the actual material it should work from. Then it answers from your facts rather than general knowledge.

What's worth adding:

Things you've written that you liked. The single best way to teach it your voice.

Reference facts you keep repeating. Prices, dates, names, the way you do a recurring thing.

A document you keep returning to. A policy, a plan, a set of rules, a manual.

Two or three good documents beat twenty. More material is not better material; it's more to search and more to get confused between.

Say what each one is. *This is our club's constitution* and *this is last year's programme* tells it how to use them, which a filename doesn't.

ONLY WHAT YOU'RE COMFORTABLE STORING

Anything you add sits there until you remove it. Apply the rule from Is This Safe?: nothing you'd mind a stranger reading, and nothing that belongs to someone else.

Try this now. Find two things you've written that sound like you. Those are the most valuable documents you own for this purpose.

06

When to keep things separate

Setting things up once has one failure mode: context leaking where it isn't wanted.

Keep separate: anything genuinely private from anything you might show someone. Work from personal, if a colleague ever looks over your shoulder. A sensitive situation — a health matter, a family difficulty, money trouble — from the space you use for ordinary things.

Use a plain conversation with no setup when the situation is one-off, when your standing rules would get in the way, or when you'd rather it *didn't* know your usual context.

That last one is worth saying plainly. Sometimes you want a general answer, not one shaped by everything it knows about you — a fresh view on a decision, or a question where your own framing is the problem.

THE CHECK BEFORE YOU SET ANYTHING UP

Ask: would I mind if this background appeared in an answer while someone was looking at my screen? If yes, it belongs in its own space, or in no space at all.

Try this now. Look at what you were about to write into a permanent setting. Decide whether it belongs there or in one conversation.

07

Keeping it current

The quiet failure. You set this up beautifully in March, and by November it describes a job you've left, a project that finished, and a tone you've gone off.

Stale context is worse than none, because it confidently shapes answers around a life you no longer have.

Read it through twice a year. Ten minutes. Delete what's finished, update what's changed, cut the rules you no longer notice.

Delete more than you add. These accumulate. A description that's grown to two pages has stopped being a summary of you.

THE REVIEW

Here's the description I set up some time ago. Ask me questions about what's changed, then give me a shorter updated version.

And if answers start feeling oddly off, check the setup before you blame the tool. A rule you set in a mood six months ago is a common cause and an easy fix.

Try this now. Put a reminder in your calendar for six months' time that says "check the about-me."

Your "about me" page

Write these six sentences once. Keep them where you can copy them — a note on your phone works. Paste them in wherever they're relevant, or put them into a permanent setting.

What I do. One sentence about work, or how you spend your time.

Who's around me. Family, customers, colleagues — only if it affects what you'd ask for.

How I sound. Three adjectives, or one sentence. Warm and brief. Plain, no enthusiasm. Dry.

What I usually want. Understanding things, drafting things, planning things, being quizzed.

The thing that changes every answer. Where I live, a constant constraint, a standing preference.

My three standing rules. The three corrections you make most often, written as instructions.

Leave out: health, finances, anything about other people, and anything you'd mind a stranger reading.

Current as of Q3 2026

The only page tied to things that change. Check you have the current edition.

Standing rules are usually set in your account settings, under a heading about personalisation or how you'd like responses written. Set once, they apply to new conversations.

Workspaces — the feature for keeping a situation's background and documents together — are called **Projects**. You create one, give it a description of the situation, and can add reference documents to it. Conversations started inside it begin already knowing that background.

Availability varies by plan. Some of this is on the free tier and some isn't, and that changes. If you can't find something described here, that is the likeliest reason.

Memory between conversations has changed over time. Assume a new conversation starts fresh unless you've set something up.

VERIFY BEFORE YOU RELY ON IT

Feature names, where the settings live, and what each plan includes all change. Check the official source — including against this page.

If you only do one thing

Take one habit and leave the other six.

Write the six sentences.

Not the workspaces, not the documents, not the standing rules — a short description of who you are, how you sound, and what you're usually trying to do, kept where you can copy from it.

Even if you never touch a single setting, pasting those six sentences at the top of a conversation makes the answer better than any technique in the rest of this series. Everything else here is a way of not having to paste them.

Ten minutes, once. It's the best trade in these books.

Do this next

Want your individual requests to land better too? → Asking Better Questions — the four things that turn a generic answer into a useful one.

Cautious about what you're storing? → Is This Safe? — especially relevant here, since a permanent setting is a permanent thing you've typed.

Attaching documents to a workspace? → Photos, Files, and Documents — how to get an honest reading of something you've handed over.

Using it on the move? → Claude on Your Phone — your setup follows you across devices.

The Everyday Claude Guides — start where you are.

DISCLAIMER

This is an independent educational guide created by Veer. It is not affiliated with, authorized by, sponsored by, or endorsed by Anthropic PBC. "Claude" and "Anthropic" are trademarks of Anthropic PBC, used here for identification and descriptive purposes only. All product features, feature names, model names, pricing, plan entitlements, and interfaces described are those of Anthropic and are subject to change; verify current details at the official source.

This guide reflects the author's own methods and opinions. Nothing in it is legal, medical, or financial advice. Information you save into a permanent setting or workspace persists until you remove it — consider what you store accordingly.

© 2026 Veer. Personal-use license — for your own use; please don't redistribute or resell.